Working hours and place of work

Harbor & Pine Studio is a small design studio based in Porto. This handbook describes the rules every member of staff works under. It is reviewed once a year and the version in this file applies from 1 January 2026.

1. Working hours

The standard working week is 36 hours. Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00 Central European Time: everyone is reachable and available for calls during that window. Outside core hours people organise their own time, as long as the weekly hours add up.

The studio is open from 08:00 to 19:00 on weekdays. There are no meetings on Wednesdays, so that the day can be used for focused work.

2. Remote work

Staff may work remotely up to three days per week. The two days in the studio are agreed in the team calendar at the start of each quarter. Working from another country for more than 10 days in a year needs written approval from the managing partner.

3. Devices and security

Every laptop uses full-disk encryption and must lock itself after 5 minutes without activity. A password manager is mandatory for all work accounts, and a lost device must be reported to the office manager on the same day.

Leave and absence

4. Annual leave

Every employee has 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over and must be taken by 31 March of the following year; anything left after that date expires.

A leave request of more than 5 consecutive working days needs at least 4 weeks' notice. Shorter requests only need the agreement of the team lead.

5. Sick leave

The first 3 days of an illness do not need a doctor's note. From the fourth day a medical certificate is required. Sick leave is paid in full for up to 20 days per calendar year.

6. Parental leave

The primary carer receives 18 weeks of parental leave at full pay. The other parent receives 6 weeks at full pay. Both periods can be taken in parts within the first two years of the child's life.

Expenses, equipment and learning

7. Expense claims

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of the purchase, using the expenses form on the intranet. Approved claims are paid with the next payroll run. A receipt photo is required for every item above 25 EUR.

8. Travel

When travelling for work, meals are reimbursed up to 45 EUR per day and hotels up to 140 EUR per night. Train travel is preferred for journeys under 6 hours; flights in economy class are reimbursed in full.

9. Equipment and learning

Each employee has an equipment budget of 1,200 EUR every three years for a laptop, plus a one-time monitor allowance of 250 EUR. The learning budget is 800 EUR per person per year for courses, books and conferences; it does not roll over to the next year.

Onboarding, feedback and conduct

10. Onboarding and probation

Every new employee is paired with a buddy for the first 6 weeks. The probation period lasts 3 months; during probation either side may end the contract with 1 week of notice. After probation the notice period is 2 months.

11. Feedback and salary

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in May and in November. Salaries are reviewed once a year, in January, together with the budget for the new year.

12. Conduct

Gifts from clients worth more than 50 EUR must be declared to the managing partner. Concerns about harassment can be raised in confidence with the trust person, Ines Carvalho, or with the managing partner. Client files are kept for 7 years and then deleted.